Teaching digital literacies

Do I teach the digital literacies students need?

WHAT IS IT?

Digital literacies are taught, drawing on Library resources where relevant

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

University contains many hidden rules: what “critical analysis” means, what a rubric is really asking for, when it is acceptable to ask for help, or what counts as “professional” behaviour. If those rules remain unspoken, familiarity can be mistaken for capability.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “Everyone else seems to know rules nobody has explained.”
- “I understand the topic, but not what I am being asked to do.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Identify which digital practices students are expected to use, from databases to citation tools.
- Teach or link to these explicitly rather than assuming prior experience.
- Integrate library or support resources into the course workflow.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A course includes a short activity on using databases and evaluating sources before the first research task is due.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

In this course, we aim to teach the digital literacies students need rather than assuming prior familiarity. If the way a class or learning activity is organised makes it harder for you to participate or understand what is…

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